03-08 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） How Seeds Travel Around the World

① A seed is small, silent and often forgotten. But inside it lives a whole plant — roots, leaves, flowers and sometimes a tall tree. The problem is, seeds cannot walk. If a plant drops all its seeds at its own feet, the young plants will grow in the shadow of the parent and fight for the same water and sunlight. So, over millions of years, plants have found **clever ways** to send their seeds to new places.

② The most famous traveller is the **wind-rider**. Dandelion seeds have a tiny white umbrella on the top. When the wind blows, the seed rises into the air and flies, sometimes for **several kilometres**. Maple seeds have a pair of thin wings that make them spin like little helicopters as they fall. These green "helicopters" can land far away from the mother tree.

③ Some seeds prefer a **boat**. Coconut palms grow near the sea. When a coconut falls, it does not break; its thick shell protects the seed, and a layer of light fibre helps it float. Carried by the ocean, a coconut can travel for **weeks** and finally land on a sandy beach thousands of kilometres away. This is why coconut palms often grow on small, far-away islands.

④ Many plants choose a more lively way: **animals**. Birds love sweet red fruits. They eat the fruit, fly a long way, and later drop the seeds to the ground in their waste. The seeds are not hurt; in fact, the bird has given them both a free ride and a small bag of natural fertiliser. Squirrels bury walnuts and acorns for winter, but they often forget where they put them. These "lost" nuts grow into new trees the next spring.

⑤ Other seeds behave almost like **hitch-hikers**. If you take a walk through long grass in autumn, you may find small brown balls stuck on your socks. These are seeds with tiny hooks. They attach to animal fur — or human socks — and only fall off hours later, perhaps in another field or another village. The famous Velcro tape was even invented by copying this idea from nature.

⑥ So next time you see a dandelion clock being blown away by the wind, or a chipmunk rushing with a nut in its mouth, remember: you are watching one of the **oldest travelling stories** on Earth. Seeds may be tiny and still, but together they keep the green world moving, from hill to hill, from continent to continent.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the main problem a plant would have if all its seeds landed at its feet?

A. The seeds would be eaten by birds.
B. Young plants would fight the parent for water and sunlight.
C. The seeds would get too cold in winter.
D. The flowers would lose their colour.

2. Which of the following is a "wind-rider" seed?

A. A coconut seed.
B. A walnut seed.
C. A dandelion seed.
D. A seed with small hooks.

3. Why can coconut palms often grow on small, far-away islands?

A. Because their seeds are blown by the wind.
B. Because their seeds can float on the sea for weeks.
C. Because squirrels carry them across the water.
D. Because they stick to the socks of sailors.

4. According to Paragraph 4, how do squirrels accidentally help trees?

A. They plant new trees on purpose.
B. They eat the old leaves of the trees.
C. They bury nuts for winter and sometimes forget them.
D. They sing songs to the baby plants.

5. What invention was inspired by seeds that stick to fur or socks?

A. The umbrella.
B. The helicopter.
C. The Velcro tape.
D. The paper boat.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段第 3 句 "fight for the same water and sunlight"
【解析】若种子全落在母树脚下，则与母树争夺水分和阳光。A、C、D 均无依据。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C

【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "Dandelion seeds have a tiny white umbrella... flies, sometimes for several kilometres"
【解析】蒲公英是典型的"风行者"。A 是海行；B 是动物传播；D 是钩挂传播。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "a coconut can travel for weeks and finally land on a sandy beach thousands of kilometres away"
【解析】椰子能在海上漂数周，因此能抵达遥远的小岛。A、C、D 均无依据。故选 B。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段末句 "Squirrels bury walnuts and acorns for winter, but they often forget where they put them."
【解析】松鼠埋核果过冬却经常忘记，长成新树。A 项"故意种树"与"forget"相反；B、D 无依据。故选 C。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段末句 "The famous Velcro tape was even invented by copying this idea"
【解析】魔术贴由带钩种子启发发明。A、B、D 与文无关。故选 C。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **dandelion** [n.] 蒲公英
- **acorn** [n.] 橡果
- **Velcro tape** 魔术贴